Gmail

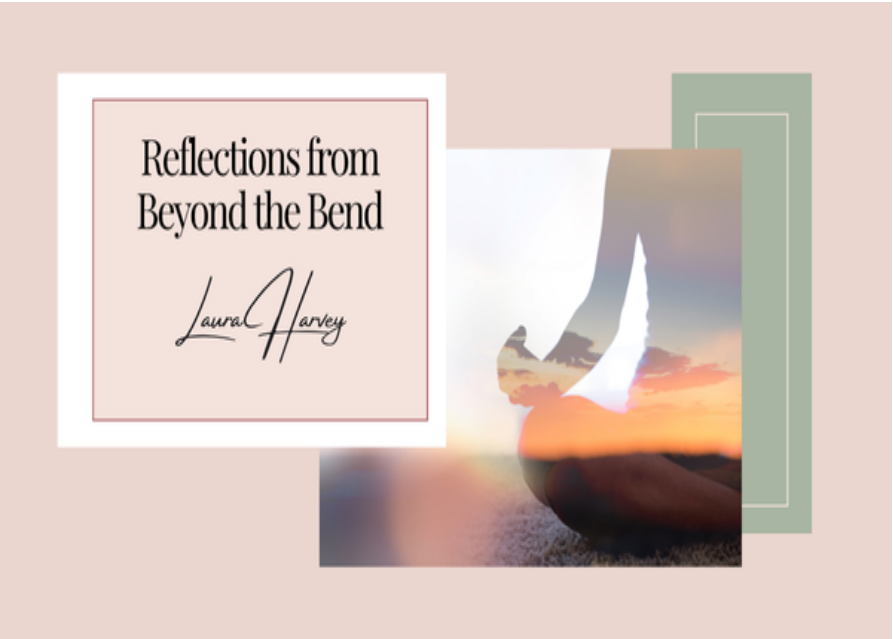
Laura Harvey <coachlharvey@gmail.com>

Reflections from Beyond the Bend

1 message

Beyond The Bend Yoga <laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca> Mon, Nov 24, 2025 at 11:37 PM
Reply-To: laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca
To: coachlharvey@gmail.com

BEYOND THE BEND YOGA



Hello Laura

I've been doing some reading lately, nothing too heavy, just something that stirred up an old word from a much earlier chapter of my life: metaphysics.

It's a word I first met in university when I was completing my philosophy degree. Back then, it lived in lecture halls and long essays and theories about being and consciousness, and while the ideas themselves stirred something in me, the way they were presented never sat quite right.

It was the tone, I think - the certainty - the sense of authority.

A line of men explaining the unexplainable with great confidence, as though truth were something they could pin down with the perfect argument. There was very little humility in it. Very little humanity. Even in the moments that were beautiful, something felt missing.

I didn't have the words for it then, but I do now:

They were circling the truth, but refusing to feel it.
They analyzed truth from every angle, but never stepped into it.

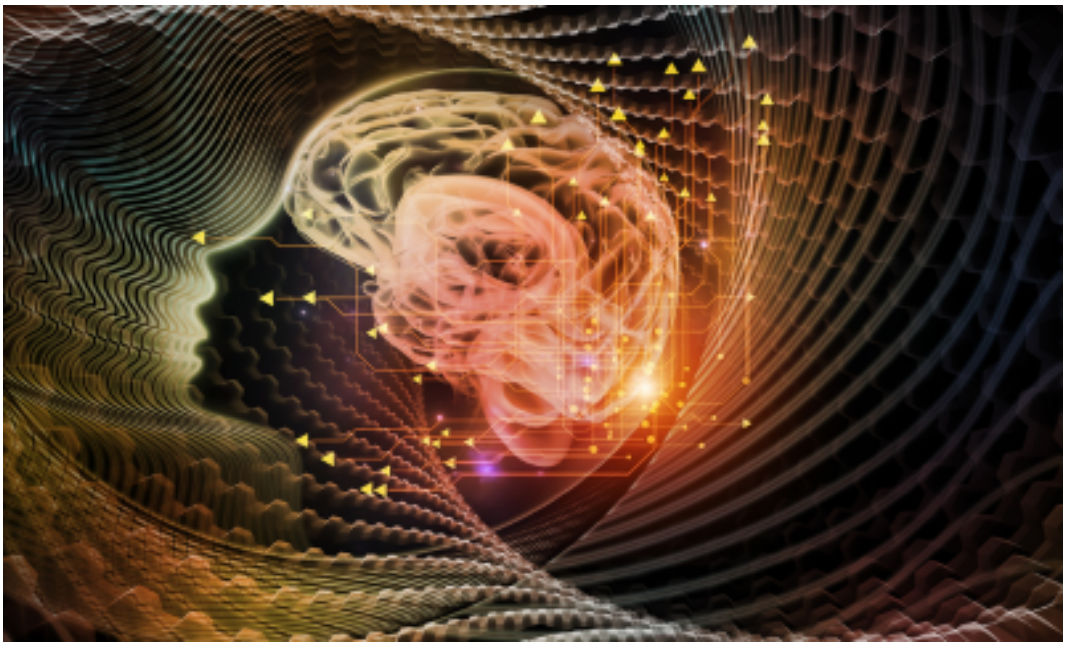
As I was reading this week, all of that came back - not as irritation, but as a kind of clarity. A recognition of how different truth feels when it's lived rather than studied. How it shows up in breath, in awareness, in the quiet space inside the body that philosophy never quite managed to touch.

That's what inspired this week's newsletter: a softer, more human look at metaphysics - one that belongs in lived experience, not in abstract explanations.

I hope it resonates with you the way it's been resonating with me.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

This Week's Wellness Wisdom



What Metaphysics Really Means

By Laura Harvey | Beyond the Bend Yoga

In philosophy, metaphysics asks questions like:

What is real?
What is the self?
What is consciousness?
What exists beneath everything we see?

But I believe the lived version feels simpler.

Metaphysics begins the moment you notice there is a part of you that can watch your thoughts instead of becoming them. It is the quiet shift from “I am thinking” to “I am aware of thinking.”

It is the softening that comes with a single breath, not because breath is magical, but because slowing down reveals layers of experience that constant thinking usually covers.

It is the deeper knowing that rises when the mind finally stops performing. Not intuition exactly, but the steady presence beneath your

thoughts, the part of you that does not come and go.

It is the sense that life has more than one layer: the outer world of doing and the inner world of being. Metaphysics is simply the curiosity that awakens when you realize both are real.

Philosophy offers the questions.
Yoga and meditation let you feel the answers.

When I look back now, I can see that this path is not new. It is the same inquiry I began decades ago, only now it lives in my body rather than in theories.

Here is what I mean:

When I watch a thought rise and fall in meditation, I feel the difference between what changes and what stays steady beneath it. It becomes a truth that is felt rather than debated.

When a single breath shifts something inside me, I understand what philosophy was reaching for when it suggested that we are never fixed but always unfolding. My body shows me what the theories were trying to name.

When stillness opens a deeper layer of knowing, I sense that reality has dimensions beneath thought, something quieter and more honest waiting below the surface.

When presence settles and I feel the part of me that does not sway with every emotion, I understand being not as an idea but as a ground I can rest in.

And when I linger in the sacred gap at the end of an exhale, that tiny effortless pause where nothing is happening and yet everything feels profoundly alive, I finally understand what philosophy was trying to touch when it spoke of pure being, the essence beneath all movement.

Philosophy circled these truths with ideas.
Yoga and meditation allow me to step into them.

January Registration Opens Soon

I'm starting to look ahead to our winter 2026 session, and **I wanted to make sure my current students hear the details first.**

Our winter 2026 classes will begin on January 12, and this will be a 12-week session running through the end of March. Because many of the fall classes have been quite full, **I'm reserving all spots for current students until December 7**. This gives you the first opportunity to keep your place in your current class or to switch into a different class before registration opens to the public.

There is one small change for the new year.
The Wednesday Morning Stillness class will now be held at Rising Moon Studio, at the same time as always, with the same gentle Hatha practice you know and love. The only change is the beautiful new location, complete with the warm glow of the fireplace.

With this shift, all four winter classes will now be held at Rising Moon Studio, creating a cozy and consistent home for the season ahead.

If you would like to continue with your class or move into a different one for January, **please reply to this email and I will reserve your spot.**

There is limited room for drop-ins in the current session as well.
Please see the schedule below for details.

Practice of the Week:

The Sacred Gap

Here is a gentle practice to explore the quiet space that lives beneath thinking, doing, and effort. This is the space where presence becomes unmistakably real.

Find a comfortable seat and allow your body to settle.
Let your shoulders fall away from your ears. Let your face soften. Let your hands rest without effort.

Take a slow inhale through your nose, feeling the breath rise and expand.

Exhale gently, as if you are letting something inside you soften.
No pushing. No shaping. Just a natural release.

At the bottom of the exhale, allow yourself to pause.
This is the sacred gap.
It is the small, effortless stillness that appears only when the breath has completely gone and before the next breath begins.

There is nothing to manage here.
Nothing to hold.
Nothing to create.

Simply let yourself hover in that quiet moment where the body is still, the breath is absent, and the mind loosens its grip.

Notice the texture of this space.
Is it spacious?
Steady?
Quiet?
Does it feel as though the world has softened?

Feel how the edges of your thoughts become less dominant.
Feel how you become more aware of what remains: the steady presence beneath movement, emotion, and breath.

Then let the next inhale arrive on its own.
Do not reach for it.
Let it come to you gently, like a tide returning to shore.

Repeat this for several rounds.
Each time you reach the bottom of the exhale, rest in that silent opening.
Let the gap widen slightly, not by holding your breath, but by easing into the naturally occurring stillness.

Notice what happens inside you when you give yourself permission to linger here.
For many people, this pause begins to feel like a homecoming, a return to a place inside that is untouched by urgency, noise, or expectation.

Let this be enough.
Let this be the practice.

The sacred gap has a way of revealing something honest and grounding.
A truth that does not need to be named or analyzed.
A truth that can only be felt in stillness, in presence, and in the soft spaces between breaths.

🌙 A Closing Thought

Metaphysics no longer feels like something abstract or academic to me.
It feels like something woven into every human moment:

in breath,
in quiet,
in stillness,
in the space between thoughts,
and especially in the sacred pause at the end of the exhale.

Thank you for exploring this with me.
Thank you for listening inward.
And thank you, truly, for being here.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

Our e-mail address is:
laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca

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